



Cashew stalks swell as the fruit ripens.

Cashew



Cashew nuts

Hollow where nuts were cracked and ground with a stone by ancient people about 10,000 years ago.

A toxic resin in the cashew shell can irritate the skin.



Peanut

The edible seed is covered by a thin, reddish brown seed coat.



Prehistoric nutting stone

Brazil nut



Extra-hard shell can be cracked open by birds with very tough beaks.



Sweet chestnut

A spiny sheath protects up to three developing nuts.



Pecan

These wrinkled nuts have a buttery flavor.

Pine nut

Stubby pine nuts can be up to 3 in (8 cm) long.



including **almonds**, **pistachios**, **coconuts**, **English walnuts**, **pecans**, and **cashews**, while **pine nuts** are seeds found inside pine cones. **Peanuts** are the strangest so-called nut. Once pollinated, peanut flowers push a stalk into the soil to produce an underground bean pod

containing up to four nutlike seeds. Since they grow beneath the soil, they are also known as groundnuts. Of the nuts shown here, **hazelnuts** and **sweet chestnuts** are the only “true” nuts. Their hard shells are the flesh of the fruit, while the part we eat is the seed.